

Homework 1

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Problem 1

Given points x, y, z, t in a metric space (X, d) prove that

$$|d(x, y) - d(z, t)| \leq d(x, z) + d(y, t)$$

Solution. We start with the triangle inequality on d

$$\begin{aligned} d(x, y) &\leq d(x, z) + d(z, y) \\ d(x, y) &\leq d(x, z) + d(z, t) + d(t, y) \\ d(x, y) - d(z, t) &\leq d(x, z) + d(y, t) \end{aligned}$$

Again

$$\begin{aligned} d(z, t) &\leq d(z, x) + d(x, t) \\ d(z, t) &\leq d(z, x) + d(x, y) + d(y, t) \\ d(z, t) - d(x, y) &\leq d(x, z) + d(y, t) \end{aligned}$$

Then we have $a \leq b$ and $-a \leq b$. Thus $|a| \leq b$.
i.e.

$$|d(x, y) - d(z, t)| \leq d(x, z) + d(y, t)$$

□

Problem 2

Suppose that d is a metric for a non-empty set X , and for any $x, y \in X$ define

$$d^{(1)}(x, y) = kd(x, y), \text{ where } k \text{ is a positive constant, } d^{(2)}(x, y) = \min\{1, d(x, y)\}, \quad d^{(3)}(x, y) = \frac{d(x, y)}{1+d(x, y)},$$

$$d^{(4)}(x, y) = d(x, y)^2$$

Prove that $d^{(1)}, d^{(2)}, d^{(3)}$ are metrics for X but $d^{(4)}$ may not be a metric for X

Solution. For each $d^{(i)}$, $i = 1, 2, 3, 4$ it is clear that each function is well defined. Let $x, y, z \in X$. Since we know that d is a metric for X it is clear that $d^{(1)}$ preserves the symmetry and non-negativity since $k > 0$, also $d^{(1)}(x, y) = 0 \iff d(x, y) = 0 \iff x = y$. Then for the triangle inequality, starting with the triangle inequality for d we have the triangle equality of $d^{(1)}$ once we multiply across by k .

Since $d^{(2)} \leq 0 \iff d \leq 0$, we see it preserves the non-negativity of d and also if $d^{(2)} = 0 \iff d = 0 \iff x = y$, also $d^{(2)}(x, y) = \min\{1, d(x, y)\} = \min\{1, d(y, x)\} = d^{(2)}(y, x)$, so it is symmetric.

Lemma 1. For all $a, b \geq 0$, we have $\min\{1, a + b\} \leq \min\{1, a\} + \min\{1, b\}$

Proof. Case (i). $a + b < 1$

$$a + b \leq \min\{1, a\} + \min\{1, b\} = a + b$$

Since both a and b are less than one, so the min picks them out

Case (ii) $a + b \geq 1$

$$1 \leq \min\{1, a\} + \min\{1, b\}$$

In any selection of a, b this holds. Since if it picks out any of the ones, it is obvious, and the case condition takes take if both a and b get picked □

For the triangle inequality

$$\begin{aligned}
d^{(2)}(x, y) &= \min\{1, d(x, y)\} \\
&\leq \min\{1, d(x, z) + d(z, y)\} \\
&\leq \min\{1, d(x, z)\} + \min\{1, d(z, y)\} \\
&\leq d^{(2)}(x, z) + d^{(2)}(z, y)
\end{aligned}$$

Once again, we see that $d^{(3)} \leq 0 \iff d \leq 0$, which is never the case, thus it is non-negative and also $d^{(3)}(x, y) = 0 \iff d(x, y) = 0 \iff x = y$. Also the symmetry of d implies the symmetry of $d^{(3)}$. For the triangle inequality

$$\begin{aligned}
d^{(3)}(x, y) &= \frac{d(x, y)}{1 + d(x, y)} = 1 - \frac{1}{1 + d(x, y)} \\
&\leq 1 - \frac{1}{1 + d(x, z) + d(z, y)} \\
&\leq \frac{d(x, z) + d(z, y)}{1 + d(x, z) + d(z, y)} \\
&\leq \frac{d(x, z)}{1 + d(x, z) + d(z, y)} + \frac{d(z, y)}{1 + d(x, z) + d(z, y)} \\
&\leq \frac{d(x, z)}{1 + d(x, z)} + \frac{d(z, y)}{1 + d(z, y)} \\
&\leq d^{(3)}(x, z) + d^{(3)}(z, y)
\end{aligned}$$

Then for $d^{(4)}$.

Assume it is a metric. Let $X = \mathbb{R}$, and choose $x = 1, z = 1.5, y = 2$

Then $d(x, y) = 1, d(x, z) = 0.5, d(z, y) = 0.5$ with d being the usual Euclidean metric

Looking at the triangle inequality of $d^{(4)}$, we get

$$1 \leq 0.25 + 0.25$$

A contradiction, thus $d^{(4)}$ is not a metric. □

Problem 3

Let (X, d_X) and (Y, d_Y) be metric spaces. For $(x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2) \in X \times Y$ let

$$\begin{aligned}
d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= d_X(x_1, x_2) + d_Y(y_1, y_2), \\
d_2((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= \sqrt{d_X(x_1, x_2)^2 + d_Y(y_1, y_2)^2}, \\
d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= \max\{d_X(x_1, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_2)\}
\end{aligned}$$

- Prove that for each of d_1, d_2, d_∞ is a metric for $X \times Y$
- Prove that for any $p, q \in X \times Y$

$$d_\infty(p, q) \leq d_2(p, q) \leq d_1(p, q) \leq 2d_\infty(p, q)$$

- Show that the open sets in $X \times Y$ are the same for d_1, d_2, d_∞
- Let U, V be open subsets of X, Y respectively. Show that $U \times V$ is d_i -open in $X \times Y$ for $i = 1, 2, \infty$

Solution. 1.

Clearly each of the metrics d_1, d_2, d_∞ are well defined due to the properties of d_X and d_Y

Let $x_1, x_2, x_3 \in X$ and $y_1, y_2, y_3 \in Y$

Clearly d_1 is non-negative since the sum of two non-neg is non-neg

Also $d_1 = 0 \iff x_1 = x_2$ and $y_1 = y_2$ implying $(x_1, y_1) = (x_2, y_2)$

Clearly d_1 is symmetric, since both d_X and d_Y are

Triangle Inequality

$$\begin{aligned} d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= d_X(x_1, x_2) + d_Y(y_1, y_2) \\ &\leq d_X(x_1, x_3) + d_X(x_3, x_2) + d_Y(y_1, y_3) + d_Y(y_3, y_2) \\ &\leq d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_3, y_3)) + d_1((x_3, y_3), (x_2, y_2)) \end{aligned}$$

Thus d_1 is a metric on $X \times X$

d_2 is non-negative since $\sqrt{a} > 0 \forall a \in \mathbb{R}$

Similarly $d_2 = 0 \iff$ the square root is 0 $\iff d_X$ and d_Y are zero $\iff$ the pairs are the same
Again due to the symmetry of d_X and d_Y it is clear that d_2 is symmetric

$$\begin{aligned} d_2((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= \sqrt{d_X(x_1, x_2)^2 + d_Y(y_1, y_2)^2} \\ &\leq \sqrt{(d_X(x_1, x_3) + d_X(x_3, x_2))^2 + (d_Y(y_1, y_3) + d_Y(y_3, y_2))^2} \end{aligned}$$

Again, the max of two non-negative numbers is obviously non-negative

Also if the max of two non-neg numbers is 0, then all are 0 implying $(x_1, y_1) = (x_2, y_2)$

Again due to the symmetry of d_X and d_Y it is clear that d_∞ is symmetric

Lemma 2. For all $a, b, c \geq 0$, we have $\max\{a + b, c\} \leq \max\{a, c\} + \max\{b, c\}$

Proof. Case (i). $a + b < c$

$$c \leq \max\{a, c\} + \max\{b, c\} = 2c$$

Since it will pick out c both times

Case (ii). $a + b \geq c$

$$a + b \leq \max\{a, c\} + \max\{b, c\}$$

In any selection this holds since if both a and b are bigger than c you get $a + b \leq a + b$, but if c is greater than one or both, evidently the sum on the right will be greater $\square$

For the triangle inequality, we get

$$\begin{aligned} d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) &= \max\{d_X(x_1, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_2)\} \\ &\leq \max\{d_X(x_1, x_3) + d_X(x_3, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_3) + d_Y(y_3, y_2)\} \\ &\leq \max\{d_X(x_1, x_3), d_Y(y_1, y_3) + d_Y(y_3, y_2)\} + \max\{d_X(x_3, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_3) + d_Y(y_3, y_2)\} \\ &\leq \max\{d_X(x_1, x_3), d_Y(y_1, y_3)\} + \max\{d_X(x_1, x_3), d_Y(y_3, y_2)\} + \max\{d_X(x_3, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_3)\} \\ &\quad \dots + \max\{d_X(x_3, x_2), d_Y(y_3, y_2)\} \\ &\leq d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_3, y_3)) + d_\infty((x_3, y_3), (x_2, y_2)) \end{aligned}$$

Thus each of the functions are metrics on $(X \times Y)$

$\square$

Solution. 2.

Let $d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) = \max\{d_X(x_1, x_2), d_Y(y_1, y_2)\} = \alpha$. Then

$$d_2((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \geq \sqrt{\alpha^2 + 0^2} = \alpha = d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \quad (1)$$

Let $d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) = a + b$, $a, b \in \mathbb{R}$. Then $d_2((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$

Then

$$d_1^2 = a^2 + b^2 + 2ab, \quad d_2^2 = a^2 + b^2$$

$$d_2^2 \leq d_1^2 \Rightarrow d_2((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \leq d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \quad (2)$$

Again let $d_\infty = \alpha$. Then $d_1 \leq \alpha + \alpha = 2d_\infty$

$$\Rightarrow d_1((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \leq 2d_\infty((x_1, y_1), (x_2, y_2)) \quad (3)$$

Combining 1,2 and 3 we get, with $p = (x_1, y_1)$ and $q = (x_2, y_2)$

$$d_\infty(p, q) \leq d_2(p, q) \leq d_1(p, q) \leq 2d_\infty(p, q)$$

$\square$

Problem 4

Let (X, d) be a metric space and consider $X \times X$ as a metric space with the metric d_1 of Problem 3. Show that $d : X \times X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is continuous

$$d_1((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4)) = d(x_1, x_3) + d(x_2, x_4)$$

Solution. Assume for the sake of contradiction that d is not continuous i.e.
Let $x_1, x_2 \in X$, then

$$\exists \epsilon > 0 \text{ such that } \forall \delta > 0 \ 0 < |x_1 - x_2| < \delta \Rightarrow |d(x_1, x_2)| \geq \epsilon$$

Aim: to show that $(X \times X, d_1)$ is not a metric space under the given assumptions

Clearly d_1 is non-negative since the sum of two non-neg is non-neg

Also $d_1 = 0 \iff x_1 = x_3$ and $x_2 = x_4$ implying $(x_1, x_2) = (x_3, x_4)$

Clearly d_1 is symmetric

Triangle Inequality

$$\begin{aligned} d_1((x_1, x_2), (x_3, x_4)) &= d(x_1, x_3) + d(x_2, x_4) \\ &\leq d(x_1, y) + d(y, x_3) + d(x_2, z) + d(z, x_4) \\ &\leq d_1((x_1, x_2), (y, z)) + d_1((y, z), (x_3, x_4)) \end{aligned}$$

□

Problem 5

Consider the set of all maps from the natural numbers to the real numbers

$$X = \mathbb{R}^{\mathbb{N}}$$

Define

$$d(x, y) = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{1}{2^n} \frac{|x_n - y_n|}{1 + |x_n - y_n|}$$

Show that (X, d) is a metric space